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VIKSIT BHARAT NEEDS ENERGY SOVEREIGNTY

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36 | INDIA SPENDS OVER \$160 billion a year on energy imports, more than its defence budget and infrastructure spending combined. Its grid loses 15% of all power generated, more than twice the global average, and its mineral wealth—lithium, cobalt, nickel—sits unprocessed beneath the earth.

DRILL EVERY DROP

India has conducted seismic surveys on less than 25% of its 3.4 million square kilometre sedimentary basin. Brazil discovered its pre-salt deepwater fields in 2006 and is on track to becoming a top-five crude exporter in 20 years. India, with comparable potential, has been encumbered by regulatory complexity and risk-aversion. ONGC estimates undiscovered offshore potential at 20–25 billion barrels.

India's undiscovered offshore reserves, if even partially recovered, can produce for decades and

reduce the import bill. Unlocking them requires a National Hydrocarbon Exploration Programme—simplified licensing, public-private co-ventures, sovereign-backed financing—that's treated as a national security imperative.

About 160 million tonnes (MT) of agricultural residue is burned across Punjab, Haryana, and Uttar Pradesh annually. Cities generate

plants. A clear mandate exists to increase the number to 5,000. Building all 5,000 would cost ₹2 lakh crore—a rounding error against the import bill—and deliver 500,000 rural jobs as a byproduct.

ELECTRIFICATION

India's petroleum bill is a mobility and cooking gas bill. Ten million trucks consume 40% of all diesel;

INDIA'S UNDISCOVERED OFFSHORE RESERVES, IF EVEN PARTIALLY RECOVERED, CAN REDUCE THE IMPORT BILL SIGNIFICANTLY

62 MT of municipal solid waste per year. Distilleries, sugar mills, paper plants, and textile units add over 150 MT of industrial organic waste. The Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE) estimates industrial waste alone holds 4–5 billion cubic metres of biogas potential a year.

The Energy and Resources Institute puts India's total biogas potential at 48–60 MT per year—one-third of current national gas consumption. India has sanctioned nearly 1,000 compressed biogas

1.5 million diesel buses run on the country's roads; 330 million Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG) households cost \$9 billion in annual imports. The passenger car and two-wheeler market is already moving—1.14 million electric two-wheelers were sold in FY25, growing at 21% year-on-year, driven by economics. Energy policy must focus where volumes and import substitution are largest.

BUILD NUCLEAR AT SCALE

India operates 8.8 GW of nuclear